

Who Pays and Who Decides: Evidence on the Table

谁承担，谁决定：摆上桌面的证据

Theme: 社会问题、经济与公共生活 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6,127

English Story

The evidence on the table concerned a **point** of law and a pile of old bills. “The **previous** administration left a **wholly irregular** account,” the auditor said. “There is no **factual** basis for the figure, and the **province** has been **lodging** the cost in the wrong column.” Nobody was **afraid** to say it aloud this time.

The **incident** that made the case was a **robbery** of the meter box and a **riot** at the water office. “A **scandal** of this size is not **occasional**,” an economist said. “It is **inevitable** while the system dissolves into a hundred small payments.” A jealous official had disturbed the record, and the **golden** seal on the **monument** outside had been stolen twice.

The **stable** next to the yard, the **foggy** morning, and the **haze** over the river all pointed to the same corner. “We cannot **climb** out of this with **encouragement** and **amusement**,” she said. “The **cornerstone** of the argument is a single account, kept in its **entirety**.”

The weather of the meeting turned when a shopkeeper spoke about a **continual** stream of small payments. “My **jealousy** of the big firms is not the **point**,” he said. “The **point** is that the meter melts my margin and the guarantee boils away.”

The committee asked for a **convenient** summary of a **monstrous** file. “A **stable** budget and a **solemnity** of procedure are not the same thing,” the mayor said. “**Legislate** quickly and the **impossibility** becomes a grievance.”

The evidence was complete enough to name the **misfortune**: a system with no single owner, a **spoil** of small favours, and a shade of doubt over every receipt. “The total is not the story,” the auditor said. “The story is who signed the **lodging** bills.” The **benefit** of the congress was a data set and a computer program that could name every county claim; the cell of auditors had nothing but a machine and a story. “This is not science,” the auditor said. “It is a system with a source and an operation, and it grieves me that it works.” A **grand disorder**, a **shady** ledger, and a **stability** bought with a **grievous** loan: the whole **fulfilment** of the account turned out to be **instantaneous** and false. Free energy was not a technology the council owned, and the county knew that too.

中文翻译

桌上的证据涉及一个法律要点和一堆旧账单。“上一届政府留下了一个完全不合规的账户，”审计员说，“那个数字没有事实依据，而这个省一直把成本寄存在错误的栏目里。”这一次没有人害怕把它大声说出来。

让这个案子成立的事件是电表箱被抢和水务办公室的一场骚乱。“这种规模的丑闻不是偶然的，”一位经济学家说，“只要系统瓦解成上百笔小额付款，它就是不可避免的。”一位嫉妒的官员扰乱了记录，而外面纪念碑上的金印已被偷过两次。

院子旁的牛棚、雾蒙蒙的早晨，以及河上的阴霾，都指向同一个角落。“我们无法靠鼓励和消遣爬出这个坑，”她说，“这场论证的基石是一个单一的账户，而且要完整地保存。”

会议的天气在一个店主谈到持续不断的小额付款时变了。“我对大公司的嫉妒不是重点，”他说，“重点是电表融化我的利润，而保证金就这样煮沸蒸发。”

委员会要求对一个庞大的档案给出一份方便的摘要。“稳定的预算和程序的庄重不是同一回事，”市长说，“匆忙立法，那种不可能就会变成一桩冤情。”

证据完整到足以给这桩不幸命名：一个没有单一主人的系统、一份小额人情的战利品，以及笼罩在每张收据上的一层怀疑。“总数不是故事，”审计员说，“故事是谁在那些寄存账单上签了字。”这场国会的好处是一份数据集和一个能为每一笔县级索赔命名的电脑程序；而审计小组只有一台机器和一个故事。“这不是科学，”审计员说，“这是一个带有来源和运作的系统，而它居然运转，这让我难过。”一场宏大的混乱、一本可疑的账，以及用一笔沉重的贷款买来的稳定：这份账目的全部履行，结果是瞬间的、虚假的。免费能源不是议会拥有的技术，而这个县也知道这一点。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
point point POS: n	n. 点, 小数点, 标点, 地点, 要点, 特点, 尖端, 分数, 得分, 穴位; vt. 弄尖, 强调, 指出, 加标点于, 瞄准; vi... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a geometric element that has position but no extension; n. the precise location of something; a spatially l...
previous 'pri:vɪəs POS: a	a. 早先的, 前面的, 过急的; [法] 以前的, 生前的, 前述的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. just preceding something else in time or order; s. too soon or too hasty
afraid ə'freɪd POS: a	a. 害怕的, 恐怕的, 遗憾的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. filled with fear or apprehension; s. filled with regret or concern; used often to soften an unpleasant stat...
climb klaɪm POS: v	v. 攀登, 上升, 爬; n. 攀登, 爬升 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an event that involves rising to a higher point (as in altitude or temperature or intensity etc.); n. the a...
incident 'ɪnsɪdənt POS: n	n. 事件, 事变, 小事; a. 附带的, 易于发生的, 外来的, 入射的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a single distinct event; n. a public disturbance; a. falling or striking of light rays on something
golden 'gəʊldn POS: a	a. 金的, 含金的, 金色的, 贵重的, 繁盛的; [法] 金制的, 金色的, 兴隆的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. marked by peace and prosperity; s. suggestive of gold; s. presaging or likely to bring good luck
grand grænd POS: a	a. 庄重的, 壮观的, 显赫的, 重大的, 最高的, 雄伟的, 宏大的, 豪华的, 傲慢的; [法] 重大的, 主要的, 伟大的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. large and impressive in physical size or extent; s. the most important and magnificent in adornment
disorder dɪs'ɔ:də POS: n	n. 杂乱, 混乱; vt. 扰乱, 使失调 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a physical condition in which there is a disturbance of normal functioning; n. a disturbance of the peace o...
province 'prɒvɪns POS: n	n. 省, 地方, 职权, 领域; [法] 省, 地方, 领域 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the proper sphere or extent of your activities
stable 'steɪbl POS: n	n. 马房, 牛棚; a. 稳定的, 安定的, 坚固的, 坚定的; vt. 赶入马房; vi. 被关在马厩 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a farm building for housing horses or other livestock; v. shelter in a stable; a. resistant to change of pos...
inevitable ɪn'evɪtəbl POS: a	a. 不可避免的, 必然的; [法] 不可避免的, 无法规避的, 必然的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an unavoidable event; a. incapable of being avoided or prevented; s. invariably occurring or appearing
occasional ə'keɪʒənəl POS: a	a. 偶然的, 临时的; [法] 偶然的, 特殊场合的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. occurring from time to time
stability steɪ'bɪləti POS: n	n. 安定, 稳定性, 坚实, 巩固; [化] 稳定性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality or attribute of being firm and steadfast; n. a stable order (especially of society)
scandal 'skændəl POS: n	n. 丑闻, 中伤, 耻辱, 反感, 流言蜚语; [法] 丑事, 丑闻, 干丑事的人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. disgraceful gossip about the private lives of other people; n. a disgraceful event
disturb dɪs'tɜ:b POS: vt	vt. 扰乱, 妨碍, 使不安; [法] 滋扰, 扰乱 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. move deeply; v. damage as if by shaking or jarring
wholly 'həʊli POS: adv	adv. 完全地, 整个, 统统, 全部; [法] 完全地, 统统地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. to a complete degree or to the full or entire extent ('whole' is often used informally for 'wholly')
melt melt POS: n	n. 熔化, 熔化物, 溶解; v. (使)熔化, (使)溶解, (使)消散, (使)变软 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. reduce or cause to be reduced from a solid to a liquid state, usually by heating; v. lose its distinct outl...
convenient kən'vi:njənt POS: a	a. 方便的, 合宜的; [法] 适当的, 合理而可行的, 方便的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. suited to your comfort or purpose or needs
riot 'raɪət POS: n	n. 暴动, 喧闹, 放纵; vi. 发动, 暴动, 纵情, 放荡; vt. 浪费, 挥霍 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a public act of violence by an unruly mob; v. take part in a riot; disturb the public peace by engaging in...
monument 'mɒnjumənt POS: n	n. 纪念碑, 纪念物, 石碑 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an important site that is marked and preserved as public property
dissolve dɪ'zɒlv POS: v	v. 溶解, 解散 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (film) a gradual transition from one scene to the next; the next scene is gradually superimposed as the fo...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
boil boil POS: n	n. 煮沸, 沸腾, 疖; v. 煮沸, 激动 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a painful sore with a hard core filled with pus; v. come to the boiling point and change from a liquid to v...
encouragement in'kʌrɪdʒmənt POS: n	n. 鼓励, 激励, 奖励; [法] 怂恿, 煽动, 助长 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the expression of approval and support; n. the feeling of being encouraged
spoil spoil POS: n	n. 战利品, 赃物, 奖品, 变质, 次品; vt. 损坏, 破坏, 溺爱; vi. 腐坏, 掠夺 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (usually plural) valuables taken by violence (especially in war); n. the act of spoiling something by causi...
amusement ə'mju:zmənt POS: n	n. 兴味, 娱乐, 消遣; [法] 娱乐, 娱乐活动 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a feeling of delight at being entertained
robbery 'rɒbəri POS: n	n. 抢掠, 抢夺; [法] 强盗, 抢劫, 劫掠 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. larceny by threat of violence
factual 'fæktʃʊəl POS: a	a. 事实的, 实际的; [法] 事实的, 与事实有关的, 实际的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to or characterized by facts
jealousy 'dʒeləsi POS: n	n. 妒忌, 猜忌, 羡慕; [法] 妒忌, 嫉妒, 猜忌 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a feeling of jealous envy (especially of a rival); n. zealous vigilance
irregular 'irɛɡjʊlə POS: n	n. 不规则物, 不合规格之物; a. 不规则的, 不整齐的, 不合法的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. merchandise that has imperfections; usually sold at a reduced price without the brand name; a. contrary to...
continual kən'tɪnjuəl POS: a	a. 持续不断的, 继续的; [建] 连续的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. occurring without interruption; chiefly restricted to what recurs regularly or frequently in a prolonged a...
fulfilment phonetic unavailable POS: n	n. 履行, 结束, 完成, 实现, 满意, 称心; [法] 履行, 实现, 完成 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a feeling of satisfaction at having achieved your desires; n the act of consummating something (a desire or...
haze heɪz POS: n	n. 薄雾, 阴霾, 疑惑; vt. 使变朦胧, 使变糊涂; vi. 变朦胧, 变糊涂 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. atmospheric moisture or dust or smoke that causes reduced visibility; v. become hazy, dull, or cloudy; v. ha...
misfortune mis'fɔ:tʃən POS: n	n. 不幸, 灾祸, 坏运气; [法] 不幸事故, 不幸, 灾祸 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. unnecessary and unforeseen trouble resulting from an unfortunate event; n. an unfortunate state resulting f...
shady 'ʃeɪdi POS: a	a. 荫凉的, 成荫的, 阴暗的, 隐蔽的; [法] 成问题的, 令人怀疑的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. filled with shade
impossibility im.pɒsə'bɪlɪti POS: n	n. 不可能之事, 不可能; [法] 不可能性, 不可能的事 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. incapability of existing or occurring; n. an alternative that is not available
cornerstone 'kɔ:nəstəɪn POS: n	n. 奠基石, 基础 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a stone in the exterior of a large and important building; usually carved with a date and laid with approp...
monstrous 'mɒnstres POS: a	a. 巨大的, 畸形的, 怪异的; [法] 巨大的, 异形的, 畸形的:荒诞的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. abnormally large
legislate 'ledʒɪsleɪt POS: vi	vi. 制定法律; vt. 用立法规定 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make laws, bills, etc. or bring into effect by legislation
grievous 'ɡri:vəs POS: a	a. 痛苦的, 严重的, 充满悲伤的; [法] 极大的, 严重的, 惨无人道的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. causing or marked by grief or anguish
foggy 'fɒɡɪ POS: a	a. 雾深的, 模糊的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s stunned or confused and slow to react (as from blows or drunkenness or exhaustion); s indistinct or hazy in...
entirety in'taɪəti POS: n	n. 全部, 整体; [法] 共有制, 整体, 全部 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being total and complete
lodging 'lɒdʒɪŋ POS: n	n. 寄宿处, 寄宿; [法] 提起, 住所 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of lodging
instantaneous ,ɪnstən'teɪnəs POS: a	a. 即时的, 瞬间的, 猝发的; [机] 瞬时的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. occurring with no delay
solemnity sə'lemnɪti POS: n	n. 严肃, 一本正经; [法] 要式, 庄严的仪式, 严肃 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a trait of dignified seriousness; n a solemn and dignified feeling